highest defence body – the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) – dealt with procurement proposals for necessary supplies or issues relating to soldiers' emoluments, not with real strategy.

At the time of India's independence in 1947, the Indian military's officer corps was unacquainted with national security management. The British started giving commissions to Indians as officers in the military only in 1920, having reserved officers' ranks exclusively for British of Caucasian descent until then. This meant that the Indian officers' corps was only twenty-seven-years-old at the time of Independence. India had inherited an army from the Raj but with inexperienced junior generals, some of whom were excellent field commanders but lacked proficiency in leading a larger force. Only three Indian generals had experience of commanding a brigade during World War II. Nehru refused to retain British generals, pushing Indians into senior command positions without adequate prior preparation.

The situation was exacerbated when generalist civil servants, with little knowledge of security issues and international relations, came to dominate the Ministry of Defence. Diplomats at the Ministry of External Affairs soon insinuated themselves into all aspects of national security. In an interview a former head of the defence department noted that for decades even the introductory chapter of the annual report of the defence ministry was traditionally written by the foreign secretary, not the defence secretary.[5] Thinking on defence and national security was seen as prerogatives of civil servants and diplomats, not of the uniformed military. Moreover, while Nehru was interested in economic planning, defence planning really started only after 1964 under American insistence in the backdrop of India's military defeat in 1962 at the hands of China.[6]

Subrahmanyam cites 'serious systemic flaws in the Indian national security structure and processes' that began under Nehru, which he believes were never fully redressed even under his successors. In his book *Defending India* (1999), Jaswant Singh joined criticism of India's early